

Epson L8180 Printer

Your studio printer

The Epson EcoTank L8180 is somewhat a unique offering that's only being sold in select markets. Photography enthusiasts and creative professionals is what this unit is aimed at, and they need to do a lot more than just printing photos. Let's see how the Epson L8180 holds up.

DESIGN

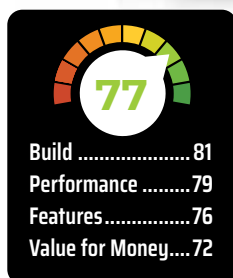
The EcoTank L8180 offers an all-in-one (AIO) solution that can print, scan, copy, and duplex. It's a substantial piece of equipment for any home office. If you're planning to have this in a studio, then it does end up taking quite a lot of space. In terms of design, the L8180 features a 10.9 cm colour touchscreen that pivots upwards for easy use. The placement of the SD Card reader could have been better. Having all the interfaces in one spot is much more convenient than having it all over the place.

The printer houses placeholders for six separate ink tanks, compatible with the 6-colour Epson Claria ET Premium Ink. The ink chamber is well-designed, with each colour having its dedicated place pointed out by clear labels. This makes it easier to check and refill individual colours as necessary. The printer also offers ample paper accommodation with two paper trays and a feeder. It can hold 50 sheets in the rear feeder, 20 in the upper front tray, and 100 in the lower front tray. A unique feature is the CD/DVD printing tray.

FEATURES

The L8180 supports bi-directional and uni-directional printing through its Micro Piezo technology, with automatic 2-sided printing up to A4 size. The printer's scanning capabilities are also noteworthy, featuring a flatbed colour image scanner with an optical resolution

₹45,958



of 1200 X 2400 dpi. For connectivity, the L8180 supports USB Type-B, Ethernet, Wi-Fi, and Wi-Fi Direct, making it versatile for various user requirements. So you can have this hooked up as a network printer, as a standalone unit or connected to a single machine via USB. It's good to see a versatile set of connectivity options.

Setting up the L8180 is a relatively straightforward process. Once you remove the packaging tapes and unlock the transportation lock, you're good to go. A recommended step is to perform a test print to verify the printer's alignment, ink levels, and paper tray functionality. The touchscreen provides visual guides for each step of the setup. If you prefer, you can also use the Epson Smart Panel app to guide you through the setup process. The printer also receives firmware updates regularly.

Lastly, the scanning area is 21.5 x 35.5 cm which is nowhere close to A3 let alone A3+, so that's something you ought to keep in mind while considering this printer.

PERFORMANCE

Like all Ink Tank printers, the L8180 is designed for high-volume printing, with the initial set of ink bottles rated to print 1,800 pages in black or 1,800 photos in colour. The printer uses Epson 115 Ink bottles as per the Epson website which at the time of writing this were extremely difficult to find. We searched all the popular eCommerce stores to no

avail and most of the links we found were servicing South Africa. We reached out to the vendors who actually service our office printers and even they had a tough time getting their hands on the 115 ink for the Epson L8180. For India, the L8180 can also make do with the 012 series Inks which cost about INR 1331 per bottle or INR 6300 for the entire set of six bottles. A new set will supposedly last you 6200 pages or 2300 photos.

The printing speed is 16 pages per minute for black and white A4 size prints and 12 pages per minute for coloured A4 size prints. In duplex mode, the speed drops to 6 pages per minute for black and white and 5 pages per minute for colour. In our tests, we managed to get 16 pages in black and white and around 11-12 pages in colour using the standard ISO24734 test sheets. Print quality is pretty good with minimal merging in moire patterns and very little banding in gradient prints. Photo prints also come out looking pretty spectacular with a quality that is pretty close to what you'd get at a studio. It does take its own sweet time for that though.

VERDICT

The Epson EcoTank L8180 is a robust and versatile printer that meets the requirements of a home office setup. For a cost of INR 45,958, this isn't exactly a cheap printer but it's optimal for good quality photo prints and also for offering a versatile set of different print tasks common to a studio. As an Ink Tank printer, its print economy is pretty good so that's one additional feather in its hat. Overall, the Epson L8180 offers a comprehensive printing solution that can cater to a wide range of user needs, making it a worthy contender in the home office printer market.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

Model: L8180 | Print res: 5760 x 1440 dpi | Ink: Epson 115 or 012 | Connectivity: Wi-Fi, Wi-Fi Direct, USB, SD Card | Scan area: 216 x 355 mm | Print Speed: 16 IPM B&W, 12 IPM Colour | Dimensions: 52.3 x 37.9 x 16.9 cm | Weight: 14.6 kg

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